Singh the most. While participating in the Bharat Mata Society with Ajit Singh, he published anti-government literature. In it, like Arjan Singh, he too protested against the pernicious government land reforms. But it was quite a different incident which led to him being crushed by the authorities. It occurred when an English police superintendent shot a pig for sport. A Muslim orderly was asked to carry its carcass. Not surprisingly, the orderly categorically refused to do so. The police superintendent promptly shot him dead. He faced no retribution for doing so. Given that killings by white officers of Indian servants were not entirely unknown, [12] the atrocity may well have been completely ignored. On 11 April 1906, however, *The Punjabee* reported the story under the heading, 'A Deliberate Murder'. The public were incandescent. An outcry arose. The authorities were stunned and taken aback. But then, instead of issuing a severe reprimand against the police officer, they prosecuted the manager of the publication, Lala Jaswant Rai, and the editor, Mr K.K. Athwale. Both were sentenced to rigorous imprisonment on 15 February 1907. [13]

Anti-British protests now erupted across Punjab. This brought Muslims, Sikhs and Hindus together. The person who led the agitation from Lahore was none other than the young Swaran Singh. For his temerity, he was duly arrested, alongside a number of Hindus, such as Gahseeta Ram, Bahaali Ram and Govardhan Dass. Along with another Sikh, Ram Singh, they were all sentenced on 20 July 1907 to one-and-a-half years' rigorous imprisonment, and one other Hindu, Gandharva Sen, received thirty lashes. The punishment in Lahore Central Jail took its toll on the young Swaran Singh. He was driven like an ox and made to toil mercilessly in unforgiving prison conditions. He contracted tuberculosis and died at the age of just twenty-three years in 1910. James Ker puts it rather euphemistically when he explains that in 1909, when the government became concerned with the spread of seditious materials in Punjab, 'proceedings were taken against Swaran Singh as well as against Kishen Singh and Ajit Singh', but that 'the cases against Sowaran Singh were withdrawn on account of an illness of which he died the following year'. [14] Swaran Singh was the same age in March 1931 as Bhagat Singh when he died.